

Every organisation wants high-performing teams. They redesign structures, clarify roles, introduce competency frameworks, establish performance management systems and invest heavily in behavioural assessments such as DiSC. These interventions undoubtedly improve organisational effectiveness. Behavioural assessments help people understand communication preferences, appreciate differences and reduce unnecessary conflict. Performance management clarifies expectations and accountability. Team structures define responsibilities and workflows. Yet organisations with equally competent people, similar behavioural profiles and well-designed performance systems often achieve dramatically different levels of collaboration and performance.

The question is why.

During a job analysis and restructuring intervention for an accounting department, our objective extended beyond redesigning roles. We administered DiSC and Team Dimensions assessments to understand how team members naturally approached communication, problem-solving and collaboration before redesigning the team's structure. The intervention revealed a well-balanced team with strong strengths in collaboration, relationship building and execution. The team displayed a predominance of Steadiness (S) and Influence (I) behavioural styles, creating a culture characterised by cooperation, stability, helpfulness and strong interpersonal relationships. The Team Dimensions analysis similarly showed healthy representation across Advancers, Refiners, Executors and Flexers, suggesting the team possessed the behavioural diversity necessary for effective execution.

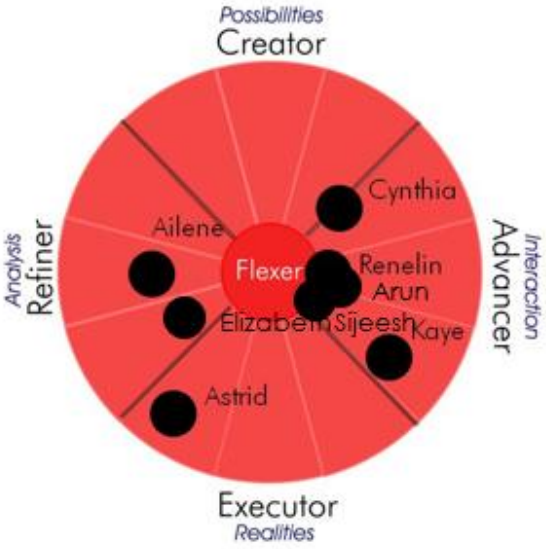
From a behavioural perspective, the team appeared well positioned for success.

Yet an important question remained.

Why do teams with appropriate behavioural diversity and clearly defined responsibilities still experience inconsistent collaboration, uneven accountability and variable performance?

The answer lies in recognising that behavioural preferences explain only part of human behaviour.

DiSC explains how people naturally communicate, solve problems and approach relationships. An individual with a high Steadiness profile naturally values cooperation and predictability. Someone with a Dominance style is inclined towards decisive action. Individuals with Influence enjoy collaboration and engagement, while Conscientiousness promotes accuracy and analytical thinking. These behavioural preferences are invaluable because they help teams appreciate diversity, reduce conflict and allocate work more effectively. They explain observable differences in behaviour.



They do not, however, explain why people decide to use those behaviours in one situation but not another.

Two employees with almost identical DiSC profiles may respond very differently to the same organisational challenge. Both may naturally value cooperation, yet one actively supports colleagues while another quietly withdraws. Two highly conscientious employees may both value accuracy, yet one willingly challenges ineffective processes while the other remains silent despite recognising significant risks. Behaviour alone cannot explain these differences.

The Worldview LOA Framework suggests that before behaviour becomes visible, individuals first make a series of deeper evaluative judgements. They determine whether organisational goals are legitimate, whether they feel genuinely responsible for contributing to collective success, and whether they believe they possess sufficient influence to make a meaningful difference. These three

evaluations—legitimacy, obligation and agency—shape the degree to which behavioural preferences are translated into sustained performance.

Seen from this perspective, DiSC describes behavioural capacity, while the Worldview LOA Framework explains behavioural activation.

An individual with a naturally collaborative DiSC profile will collaborate only if collaboration is perceived as legitimate, worthwhile and personally meaningful. Likewise, an employee with strong analytical tendencies will challenge assumptions only if they believe the organisational environment gives them permission to exercise that judgement. Behavioural potential therefore becomes organisational performance only when deeper evaluative structures reinforce it.

This perspective also changes the way we think about performance management.

Traditional performance management concentrates on objectives, competencies, scorecards and annual reviews. While these remain essential, they often assume that once expectations are communicated, employees will naturally pursue them. Experience repeatedly demonstrates otherwise. Performance conversations are interpreted through individual worldviews long before they influence behaviour. Developmental feedback may be experienced as encouragement by one employee, criticism by another and indifference by a third. Stretch objectives may inspire one team member while overwhelming someone else. Performance management therefore succeeds not simply because goals are clear, but because employees judge those goals to be legitimate, experience ownership for achieving them and believe they possess the agency to influence the outcome.

The DiSC intervention reinforced another important insight. Behavioural diversity should not be viewed as a source of conflict but as an organisational capability. The accounting team contained individuals naturally inclined towards relationship management, process refinement, execution and operational support. This diversity strengthened the team's collective capability. However, diversity alone could not guarantee collaboration. Genuine collaboration emerged only when individuals appreciated one another's contributions and understood how their different behavioural strengths served a common organisational purpose. The assessments therefore became less about categorising personalities and more about creating mutual understanding and trust.

This is where executive judgement becomes the missing dimension of team effectiveness.

High-performing teams are not distinguished by personality similarity. They are distinguished by shared interpretation. Members develop a common understanding of what the team exists to accomplish, why those objectives matter and how each individual's contribution supports collective success. They learn to interpret organisational priorities through a common evaluative lens while continuing to contribute their own behavioural strengths.

For leaders, the implications are significant. Behavioural assessments such as DiSC should not be regarded as endpoints in team development but as starting points. They help leaders understand how individuals prefer to communicate, collaborate and solve problems. The Worldview LOA Framework extends this understanding by explaining why individuals choose to activate—or

suppress—those behavioural preferences within particular organisational contexts. Together, these perspectives provide a far richer understanding of team performance than either framework offers independently.

Ultimately, high-performing teams are not created simply by assembling complementary personalities or implementing robust performance management systems. Nor are they created by organisational structures alone. Sustainable performance emerges when behavioural diversity is united by shared executive judgement. When team members judge organisational objectives to be legitimate, experience genuine responsibility towards one another and believe they possess the agency to contribute meaningfully, behavioural strengths become collective capability. Under those conditions, DiSC profiles cease to describe merely how people differ. They begin to explain how those differences become one of the team's greatest competitive advantages.